

FILM

Master at WORK

There isn't a single music director who doesn't acknowledge the contribution of Rahul Dev Burman to his oeuvre. A genius far ahead of his time in terms of melody, rhythm, improvisation and modernity, Pancham was so called by his father, the legendary music director Sachin Dev Burman, because his cry matched the musical note *Pa*. A school dropout, he started his career as an assistant to his father, and the bio-pic, *Pancham Unmixed*, by Brahma-nand Singh and Gaurav Sharma, is a work that matches his passion. It provides insight into the man's life through anecdotes narrated by his wife, singer Asha Bhosle, his colleagues, actors and music directors. What comes across is a humble Panchamda who was open to innovations. Singer Kavita Krishnamurthy who worked with him in his last hit, *1942: A Love Story*, says he would never reprimand a singer in the studio in front of the musicians, but would gently point out mistakes in the booth. Guitarist Bhanu Gupta recalls how he heard



PANCHAM UNMIXED
Shemaroo Entertainment
Rs 999



**PANCHAM WITH
WIFE ASHA
BHOSLE**

him strumming a particular rhythm pattern, he left his bath midway, wrapped himself in a towel and played the melody on the harmonium. That was *Musafir hoon yaron* from *Parichay*. Gulzar had a special relationship with him. "He knew which melodies would suit my lyrics and kept certain songs exclusively for me," he says. Music director Shantanu Moitra adds Panchamda knew how to use folk instruments in a contemporary way. The film also talks about Burman's last days when he was not sought after. The pack includes a book with photos and a DVD of 30 songs. A must for Panchamda's fans. **by S. Sahaya Ranjit**

IF YOU HAVE 90 MINUTES, get a dose of Indian music and dance at the SPIC MACAY Festival 2010 starting January 29 at various schools and colleges across India, featuring Ustad Amjad Ali Khan and Pandit Birju Maharaj, among others.



RANI USHA DEVI

PHOTO-ART EXHIBITION

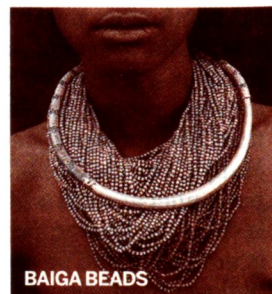
Art of Capture

What Matthieu Foss Gallery is Mumbai's first gallery dedicated solely to photo-based art. Frenchman Matthieu Foss has created a hub from the traditional analog to the recent digital photographs. He was also a team member of Paris Photo, an international annual photo fair, in 2007.

Why To make photography accessible to the city and to promote it among artists and patrons.

What's on Curtains will open with an exhibition of photographs by a Montreal-born photographer, Marcus Leatherdale. Scouring the nooks and corners of India for 17 years, Leatherdale has captured the cultural peculiarities and multiple ethnicities that make up India.

by Mitali Patel



BAIGA BEADS